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**INSTITUTE OF OPEN DISTANCE & e-
LEARNING**

IN COLLABORATION WITH

SCHOOL OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

AHT 112: INTRODUCTION TO POLITICAL SCIENCE

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LECTURE 1

GROWTH OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

INTRODUCTION



Political science is a category of knowledge that contributes to the study of politics, political systems and the political behaviour of human beings. Political science is a branch of social sciences.

Other disciplines in the social sciences include; psychology, sociology, anthropology and economics, Political science concerns itself with the study of local, state and national politics and governance, international relations, political theory and history.

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- To define political science and locate it within the spectrum of social sciences
- To have an overview of the growth of political science from institutionalism to behaviouralism/ positivism and ultimately to post positivism.

Political science This is a diverse and constantly changing fields of inquiry into the political behaviour of individuals and groups of human beings, the institutions with which mankind identifies and governs itself and the values that underlie political thought systems

Growth of Political Science

The growth of political science could be divided in two categories. These categories are both chronological and methodological. From 1900 to 1950 political science focused on study of institutions. The focus was on questions relating to the institutions that make up the polity and the rules and conventions that developed to allow political institutions to function. Political science emphasized description by comparative method of institutions such as; constitutions, legal systems and government structures. The study of political science up to 1950 was synonymous with the study of the state and institutions which the state to function. This study of institutions made political scientists to point out that the methodological approach prior to 1950 was **institutionalism**.

In the study of these institutions political scientists put strong emphasis on concepts such as formal and informal rules, political standards, norms and guidelines for acceptable political behaviour. Scholars who are institutionalists sought to answer questions such as “How a government works and not “How it should work”.

In the post Second World War particularly after 1950 there were many criticisms against institutionalist perspective of political science. They included inter alia:

- Focus on formal institutions limited scholars to inquire into broad issues that influence human behaviour in a socio-political and cultural environment.
- Institutionalists concentrated on formal institutions instead of inquiring into informal solutions
- Institutionalists were preoccupied with discussing what constituted good governance rather than analyzing factors that led to good and bad political behaviour.
- Institutional political scientists were concerned with organizations or corporate institutions e.g. parliament, political parties, civil service, judiciary and avoided the study of individual behaviour which is fundamental in understanding human behaviour in a political environment.
- Political science knowledge based on study of institutions was descriptive and could not be useful to predict political outcomes.

This **criticism** led to a shift in the study of political science where political science was concerned with studying individual behaviour. From 1950 to the end of the 20th century, political science was

concerned with looking for ways to improve society by enhancing political institutions, increasing public participation and ultimately address politically based social problems.

The new methodological approach was a deliberate departure from description to application of scientific principles in the study of political phenomena and processes of governance. This scientific study of politics and governance was based on; Precise observation, counting and measuring where possible, a clear statement of hypothesis and. By the 1960s through 70s, 80s and 90s political science was associated with the study of political behaviour of people in real social, economic, ecological and cultural situations. Political science revolved around the following cardinal issues;

- One can discern commonalities in political behaviour. These commonalities can be described as theories or generalizations. Political science can predict political outcomes through the use of scientifically acceptable rules and procedures.

These procedures are; verification, observation, quantification, and measurement

- Institutional behaviour is the behaviour of individuals
- Political science is an integral part of social sciences and must be studied as an integral part of other social science disciplines.
- For the behaviour lists the most important question is” Why do individuals, institutional actors, groups and nation states behave the way they do?”

Behaviouralist political science knowledge has dominantly addressed issues of poll i.e. prediction of outcomes of general elections, referendums. It has also dealt with highlighting functions of committees in parliament and political parties and how the behaviour of members of these committees influences decisions in political parties and parliament.

There has been also been increasing analysis of behaviour of civil servants and how they facilitate our understanding of the civil service.

There is a third phase of the growth of political science which has emerged in the 1990s and the first decade of the 21st century. In terms of **methodology**, political scientists refer to it as post

positivists or post behaviorist or post modernism. This is knowledge produced by political scientists which is a blending of institutionalism and behaviouralism.

It is also a re-invention of the use of description, narration and interpretation in the study of aspects that constitute politics and governance. In the postmodernist/post positivist methodology political science has witnessed a come back of institutionalism. However, this institutionalism is different from the one of pre 1950 period in the sense that it focuses on the following aspects;

- The manner, in which power is gained, held and exercised in political circumstances.
- The way in which values are shared and disseminated among members of political groups
- On the interactions between political institutions and individuals
- In the contemporary methodological approach political science there is a shift from focusing on organizations towards rules. There is also a change from studying formal concepts to informal definitions of institutions. There is emphasis of the dynamic aspects of institutions as opposed to static approach of study of institutions. The new genre in political science puts focus on individual parts and components of institutions as opposed to holistic view of institutions. Lastly, the study of institutions is derived from the understanding that they are not independent entities rather component units embedded in societies.
- In the period 1990 towards the end of the first decade of the 21st century, key topics in political science include; gender, governance, democracy, state, electoral systems, public administration, public policy, comparative and international politics, role of minorities in mainstream politics, issues of representation, systems of governments, international relations, human rights, peace, conflict management and resolution.

SUMMARY



In this lesson we have discussed the growth of political science in the last one century. We have noted that political science was based on the study of institutions that constitute political structures and systems of governance prior to 1950. During this period political scientists were concerned with describing, narrating and interpreting formal institutions such as political parties, national assembly, judiciary, constitutions, civil service and pressure/interest groups.

After 1950 there was a development in the study of political science whereby the discipline adopted scientific techniques and methodologies in studying political issues and systems of governance. In the post 1950 period emphasis was put on understanding the dynamics of individual behaviour in political environments.

The purpose of studying individual and organizational behaviour was to make political science to take its rightful place in development as a branch of knowledge which can assist leaders and citizens to make prediction of electoral processes and referendums. It was assumed that the leadership and people could use these predictions that were derived from use of scientific techniques to make informed decisions. In the lesson we have also pointed out the major areas of study that constitute political science. In summary the lesson has identified three approaches that have determined the growth of political science knowledge since 1900. These are institutionalism, positivism/behaviouralism and post positivism or post modernism.

ACTIVITIES



Assignment

Assignment 1

Discuss the historical development of political science as a discipline since 1900.

Assessment

Assessment 1

What specific criticism was leveled against the use of institutional approach in the study of political science?

Why has institutionalism been re-invented in the last decade of the 20th century and first decade of 21st century?

LECTURE 2

THEORIES OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

INTRODUCTION



Political science just like any other discipline is founded on specific rules, procedures and systems in which knowledge is produced and disseminated. A theory could be defined as a paradigm or framework of prism in which ideas, phenomenon, events, processes and issues are organized, analyzed, discussed and presented.

It is a theory and methodology that give distinction to various genres of knowledge. Political science has specific theories that are used in the study of politics and governance. These theories include; Rational theory game theory, mathematical theories, Marxist and neo Marxist theories, political development or modernization theories, post modernist theories.

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- To have a concise understanding of theories used in the study of Political science.

Rational choice Theory

This theory emanates from the idea that people make decisions in order to gain maximum benefits.

This theory developed in the field of economics whereby it referred to a process of maximising

utility. Rational choice theory increasingly became popular in political science in the 1960's and 1970's.

In political science rational choice theory is used to analyze the manner in which groups of individuals respond to challenges in political institutions, public policy and other political phenomena. This theory emphasizes that man and woman are not merely passive and reactionary participants in political processes. Individuals are indeed purposive and pro-active agents in mainstream politics. Individual's aim at maximising profits/benefits and gains by the manner in which they engage in political process. Rational choice theory emphasizes the role of the individual and not the group in the political process. The individual deliberately, consciously and rationally makes decisions in a given political scenario with a view of making maximum gain or profit or benefits. This theory is founded on the following elements:

- People are goal orientated and purposive
- People prioritize their preferences or utilities
- People make rational calculations putting into account their prioritized benefits of alternative decisions and the costs both positive and negative of alternative decisions.
- Political behaviour is based on the maximum benefit an individual is able to gain. If one can use the example of individuals participating in a by- election or a general election then before one casts his/her vote they will have to ask questions such as; What benefit will I gain if I elect party A or party B . What gain will I get if I voted for Individual or individual B. When the votes are eventually counted a certain party emerges the winner not because of the ideology of that party but because of the fact that the manifesto of the party assured individual voters of specific gains or benefits once the party is in power. A second example could be a political situation where individuals participate in demonstrations or civil disobedience or mass action. Individuals weigh the benefit of participating in a demonstration and the losses of abstaining from participation in such a demonstration. For instance members of a trade union could decide to boycott work even when they are aware that the employer could sack them. But the employees calculate and find that they might lose a salary or allowance for one month but ultimately gain over 50% salary increase.

The essence of rational choice theory is to help a political scientist to be aware that in studying political behaviour one has to identify some of the supposedly gains or benefits that could have persuaded individuals or groups of individuals to participate in a given political event or process.

Game Theory

This theory is used to predict future events and behaviour, to explain phenomena, to investigate problems, to describe events and to prescribe possible solutions or remedies to political issues, conflicts or crisis. This theory is based on an endeavour to develop universal principals that explain conflict, cooperation, resolution and management. This theory is relevant in political science in the sense that political processes have inherent manifestations of conflicts which have to be addressed to put a state or nation in unity.

Mathematical approaches or statistical approaches

This approach reduces political behaviour into phenomena that is measurable, observable and deductive. The theory ignores the sociological, cultural and economic factors that could influence political behaviour. The purpose of statistical and mathematical approaches in political science is to make prediction of possible outcomes or developments in political processes. Political science as a discipline is called upon to assist the citizen and the ruler to have accurate information on possible future outcomes. For instance in a General election the people would want to know which party or candidate will win and why. Thus political science has developed opinion polls as a method of predicting outcome of elections and referendums. These opinion polls could also be used to make general conclusions on the future of the regime in power and even the direction of economic development in a nation.

Marxist and neo Marxist theories

These theories are used popularly by historians but over time they have gained a place in political science. Political science has a category of knowledge called political economy which can only be understood if one has a grasp of Marxist and neo Marxist theories.

Marxist theories focus on the following key issues;

- Class struggle or class conflicts are the force that drives politics in a society. It is the force that destroys one system of government and establishes the other. It is the class struggle that leads to revolutions. Class struggle emanates from class consciousness, a feeling where a group of citizens who share common economic conditions organize to improve their lot.

It is this class consciousness that results into formation of political parties, trade unions, and civil society organizations. Politics is indeed the outcome of class consciousness and class struggle.

- Modes of production as substructure of the political systems in a society or state. It is the mode of production that defines the politics and governance in a state. In a feudal mode of production, the political system and administration is manifested in form of a monarchy or kingship/queen ship form of government. In a capitalist mode of production democracy is the common form of governance and multi-party politics the dominant political process. In a socialist mode of production the system of government is socialism.

Marxist theories are no longer fashionable in political science. The collapse of Soviet Union led to decline of Marxist theories.

Neo Marxist theories emphasize the concept of dependency and underdevelopment. The argument by neo Marxists is that developing countries have been forcefully designated to specific roles in the international political economy. This theory focuses on: Unequal exchange of products and services between the developed worlds in. Europe, North America, Japan, New Zealand, Australia and the developing world namely Asia, Africa and Latin America. Unequal exchange is the cause of poverty and poor systems of governance in the developing world. The politics of the developing world is influenced by the geopolitical interests of Europe and North America. The developing countries can only develop and acquire sustainable systems of governance if they disengage from the developed world.

This theory was popular in political science in the post second world war period when the Soviet Union engaged United States of America in the cold war. Since the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1992, Marxist and neo-Marxist theories lost credibility.

Modernization Theories/Political Development theories

These theories were developed specifically to study political phenomena and governance in developing countries. These theories are also referred to as political development theories.

Modernization theories have the following sub theories:

- **Structural functionalism;** this is a theory developed by sociologists to study human societies. This theory states that there exist structures that form organs. Once the structure performs their functions optimum then the structure evolves or grows or meets its objectives. Political scientists adopted this theory to explain the functions and inter relationships of institutions or structures in political systems and governments. In a nut shell, a government is an organ that has structures. The structures consist of the civil service, national assembly, judiciary, political parties, trade unions and civil society organizations. In a modern government these structures ought to function in harmony. Poor governance and political conflicts arise in a society because the structures that form the authority or government have failed to perform their ascribed roles. The relevance of this theory is that politics and governance is a corporate function of structures of institutions in a society.
- **Communication theory;** this theory emphasizes the role of communication as an important integral component of politics and governance. In states where the system of communication between the government and the people or leaders and the ruled is poor the outcomes is conflicts, crises and strife. Poor communication also results to poverty in the sense that the people are not able to adhere to development projects mooted by the government. Poor communication systems also results into disintegration of political institutions such as political parties, trade unions, professional organizations and other civil society organizations. Effective communication is founded on a two way system of communication where information follows freely from the leadership top the people and vice versa from the people to the government. Political scientists have borrowed this theory from psychology and have emphasized that effective communication ought to be structured on the principals of a nervous system in a human body.

The government of a nation or a party is the nervous system which co-ordinates the overall system of communication.

Statist theory: This theory concentrates on components that make up the corporate structure of a state. The theory identifies monopoly of instruments of violence, an impartial civil service and the

territorial boundaries in which authority is exercised in a state as basic issues that concern political science. In the developing world statist theory is employed to capture the correlations between participation of the people in the political process and the position of the state in the political process. Emphasis is put on the nature of the state in Africa, Asia and Latin America. It is argued that to understand the dynamics of politics and governance one has to examine the state in terms of its form. The state is said to be over developed in relation to other aspects of society e.g. the economics. Secondly the state does not have legitimacy to rule in the sense that it does not exercise authority in all geographical locations that define its boundaries. There are other contestants that challenge the authority of the government in the state. Political scientists such as Goran Hyden adopted the concept soft state to discuss the nature of governance and politics in Africa in the 1970s. In the last part of the 20th century political scientists have emphasized the state in two ways namely developmental state in the period just after independence and a state in crisis or disintegration or failed state at the turn of the 21st century. All these conceptualizations are relevant in understanding politics and governments in the developing world.

Post Modernist theories: These theories consist of; feminism, Gender, human rights, information and communication technology and globalization.. Post modernism has been shaped by revolutionary changes that have taken place at the global level since the Second World War. These include advances in technology such as computers, cellular phones, high speed data transmission, consumerism and world capitalism. Post modernism also refers to the way special interest groups use global press, fashion and the arts to manipulate and manage the images of political events, economic issues and social issues.. According to Oakley (2002) post modernism refers to the extensive cultural changes that have taken place in western societies since the end of the Second World War.

Some of the major phenomena include;; emergence of a global economy, weakening of radical politics and the collapse of the soviet union, loss of faith in the power of rationality to bring about freedom and the explosion of information and communication technology and massive spread of popular culture. The concept of sovereignty, nation state are on the decline and instead the larger and corporate concept of supra states or regional governments are on the increase. The issue of a global village and global government have overshadowed individual nation states. The force of the market is the most important component in modern political and social science discourse.

The above theories have been categorized into two broad categories namely the rational theories which consist of game theories, mathematical theories and rational choice theories. The second strand is called interpretive theories which consist of modernization, Marxist/neo-Marxist and post modernist theories.

In the contemporary period political science adopts interdisciplinary approach in its stud. None of the above theories can adequately explain or interpret political phenomena. Rather it is the use of one or more paradigms from different disciplines in social sciences that ultimately facilitate the study of political science.

SUMMARY



This unit has identified three main approaches in the study of political science. These approaches or theoretical framework are; rational choice theory, game theory, statistical or mathematical models, modernization or political development theory, Marxist/neo-marxist theory and postmodernist theory. We have identified core aspects of these theories and emphasized that in the contemporary era political science study has adopted an inter disciplinary approach, where it relies on theories in sociology, economics, humanities, psychology , cultural anthropology and natural science to study political behaviour, political processes and systems of government.

ACTIVITIES



Assignment

Assignment 2:

Discuss the strengths and limitations of rational choice theories and interpretive theories in the Study of political science.

Assessment

Assessment 2

Identify and evaluate core aspects of post modernist theories as used in political science.

LECTURE 3

ELEMENTS OF POLITICAL SCIENCE: GOVERNMENT

INTRODUCTION



Political Science as a social science discipline is made up of core elements or units or sub disciplines. The study of these units constitutes a corporate body of knowledge called political science. Scholars with different persuasions emphasize one units or units at the expense of the others.

However, at an introductory level one needs to have basic understanding of the core elements that constitute political science. These elements include; Government, Politics, Political Theory, International Relations, Political Economy, Peace, Conflict Resolution and Management. In this unit we will focus our study to issues that deal with government.

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- To have basic knowledge on what is a government and the various systems of governments in human social formation
- To understand the role of the citizen in governance and the processes which the citizen adopts to engage a government.

(A) What is a Government?

A government is a key concept that can be described as the dynamo of political science. A government can be described broadly as institutions responsible for making collective decisions for a country or nation or society.

These institutions are managed by individuals and thus in more simple terms a government could be used to make reference to the top level leadership in institutions that make collective decisions in a country.

This top level leadership could be; presidents, Prime ministers, Ministers, Military commanders, Kings/Queens, judges, top civil servants and chairman of Commissions. In many societies and countries the dominant institutions that form a government are; Executive Council; this consists of the President and or Prime Minister, Cabinet and Civil Service. The second institution is the Legislature. This consists of the National Assembly or parliament, Senate and devolved Councils. The third institution is the Judiciary which is made of; Supreme court, Appeal Court, High Court and low courts. The last institution(s) is made of Commissions established by the constitution.

(B) Aspects of Governments

A government is characterized by the following key aspects; the State, sovereignty, authority and legitimacy. A **state** connotes a political community formed by a territorially defined population which is subject to one central authority. A state also describes a capacity of a political community in a defined territory to enter into acceptable relations with other states.. A central feature of the state is its capacity to regulate the legitimate use of force within its boundaries. Gerth and Mills (2003) noted that a state is a human community that successfully claims monopoly of the legitimate use of physical force within a given territory. Thus any state must uphold its claim to regulate the legitimate use of coercion within its domain.

Sovereignty is another outstanding component of a government. Sovereignty describes the ultimate source of authority in society or a country. The sovereign is both the highest and the final decision maker within a community. Sovereignty has two categories namely internal and external .**Internal sovereignty** refers to the autonomy of law making in a territory. The ability of recognized authority to make binding legislation that is acceptable to the citizens. It also describes recognition of the central authority and or devolved authority by the people or citizens in that particular territory. **External sovereignty** describes the international recognition of the sovereign's jurisdiction over its authority. In simple terms external sovereignty is the recognition of political

autonomy of a state by the international community. It is possible to have internal sovereignty in a state without that state having international recognition. An example is the Eritrea state and Somali land in the horn of Africa.

Authority and legitimacy is another important aspect that defines a government. Martin Harop(199) defines authority as the right to rule. Authority is the right to act and not the power to act. Authority creates its own [power so long as people give consent to the individual or group of individuals or institutions the right to make decisions or the right to act or the right to rule.. A legitimate system of government is one based on authority.

In other words the people or citizens subject to the state recognize the state's right to make collective decisions. A German sociologist Max Weber identified three ways in which power in a state is validated. These ways are;

Traditional authority; this is the authority based on custom or traditions of a people. Monarchism or kingship can be classified in this category of traditional authority. In pre-colonial African political systems we also had councils of elders that wielded authority such authority could also be described as traditional authority.

The second aspect of authority is **charismatic**. This is authority that is derived from intense commitment to the leader and his message. The leader is obeyed because he/she inspires followers who credit such leaders with exceptional and supernatural qualities. Charismatic authority is common among revolutionary leaders. In Africa leaders such as Jomo Kenyatta of Kenya , Kwame Nkrumah of Ghana, Julius Nyerere of Tanzania, Nelson Mandela of South Africa.

The last category of authority is referred to as **legal-rational authority**. This is authority based on elaborate and clearly defined principles, procedures, rules, regulations, laws and policies. A leader or group of leaders or institutions that wield power have to conform to these laid down principles, laws, policies, rules and procedures.. Here authority is derived from the office which a leader holds

and not as a result of his/her charisma and or his/her traditional values. Here the government exercise authority on the basis of rules and not in an arbitrary manner. A legal- rational authority is the dominant system of government in modern societies. This legal-rational authority limits abuse of power by leaders in positions of power in a state. When the authority of the government is widely accepted such authority is described as legitimate.

(c) Types of Governments

Human societies have developed many types of Governments. However, the most common include; Monarchies, Democracies, Socialist and Military. However, there have been other types of government which could be described as transitional and these include; Fascist, communist , colonial and post colonial governments.

Monarchy

This is a government where the sovereign is a king or queen. The King or Queen is head of state and head of government. Authority is derived from the royal family of which the King or Queen is a member. All other members of the society who are not members of the royal clan are excluded from the government and political process. Power is concentrated in an individual. Institutions like the legislature, judiciary and commissions are not developed. There is excessive abuse of power by the sovereign. This system of government has been part and parcel of evolution of human societies since the Egyptian and Mesopotamian civilizations in 1500 .B.C. However with the development of science and technology and eventual establishment of industrial revolution in the 18th and 19th centuries this type of government has disintegrated. In Europe monarchism was based on a feudal system of production. In Africa it was based on slave labour. Monarchism was prevalent in Europe in the 12th to 18th Century. In Africa it was dominant in the 12th and 19th century, Monarchism is still dominant in parts of Middle East and Asia. In modern Europe monarchism still exists but the King/Queen are ceremonial. They do not control government or the state. They are symbol of unity and identity. United Kingdom, Netherlands, Belgium just to name a few still has monarchy as an appendage to their systems of government. States in Middle East and parts of Asia are still ruled by monarchy systems of governments. In Africa, Swaziland and Morocco are monarchies.

Democracy

This is a system of government that is popularly accepted as ideal in contemporary human societies. This system of government had its origins in ancient Greece specifically Athens and Sparta.. However aspects of democracy could also be traced in ancient societies in Mesopotamia, Phoenicia and India. One of the presidents in the United States of America Abraham Lincoln defined democracy as a government of the people by the people for the people. Other definitions of democracy are; Government of the people exercised either directly or through elected representatives. In a democracy the common [people are considered as the primary source of [political power. This system of government emphasizes social equality and respect for the individual within a community.

The features of democracy include majority rule, air, transparent and regular elections, existence of political parties with well defined political ideology and clear separation of power and functions among the institutions of government such as legislature, judiciary and executive council. Lastly in a democracy there is a strong participation of people through their representative organs in governance. Democracy has the following salient principles; open, accountable and diverse mass media.. The mass media provides an equal opportunity for all actors to contribute to public policies, legislation and debates. It provides timely information to the parties in the opposition and the people what indeed is taking place in government institutions. It allows equal opportunity for the citizen to access divergent views on specific debates that are of national importance. It is the mass media that controls the democratic process. If the media is gagged then the political space is monopolised by the sovereign or the individuals or institutions in power.

The second principle of democracy is economic liberalization. This means the state or the government does not control the process of producing and reproducing wealth or money or capital. The people are left to develop innovativeness in creation of capital or wealth. This innovation leads to competition and the competition determines the forces of supply and demand on the market. Democracy is based on the principle of free market economy where supply and demand are outcomes of the market forces.

In such an economy the state concentrates on decentralization and developing smaller units of the economy controlled by individuals and their organizations.

Thirdly, democracy is propelled by the principle of rule of law³ and equality before the law. Emphasis is put on the rule of law. Justice is dispensed on the basis of a constitution and the laws that emanate from that constitution. Each individual whether poor or rich, educated or illiterate, a leader or a common citizen has equal opportunity to seek and receive justice. The law has to be documented so that citizens are aware of their entitlements in accordance with provisions of the law. The constitution has to be documented and made available to the citizen for them to understand what their obligations, duties and rights are in the constitution.

Lastly, in a democracy is characterized by freedom of speech, debate and enquiry. This freedom creates a culture where the citizen openly criticises government agenda, government policies, and government models of economic development and also provides alternative ways of addressing socio-economic and political challenges facing a country or a people. On the other hand government represents rationally engage the people in such debates and the outcome is enactment of policies and laws that are responsive to the needs of the people.

There exist two forms of democracy namely direct democracy and representative democracy. A direct democracy provides for all members of the society to participate as individuals in administrative structures. This is only possible in small groups or societies. A representative democracy allows citizens within a country to elect representatives to act on their behalf or interest as proxies and with authority to make binding decisions on behalf of the citizen. The representatives elected represent constituencies or counties or federal states. These representatives are either members of parliament, senators, Governors or congress men and women.

In representative democracy there is emphasis on promotion and protection of individual rights and freedoms. Where such rights are protected and promoted the government is referred to as a liberal democracy.

In a liberal democracy there is separation of power and functions and roles between the legislature, judiciary and executive council for the purposes of stopping abuse of power and violation of citizen's rights and freedoms.

United States of America is a model of representative democracy in the world. United States of America has been nurturing its democracy since 1776. Other role models of democracy include; Britain, Germany, France in Europe. In Asia India is a vibrant democracy. In Latin America we have Brazil and in Africa we have Botswana and South Africa.

SUMMARY



In this unit we have examined various aspects that constitute a government. We have also made reference to some of the features that constitute monarchy and democratic systems of government. We have pointed out that a government is one of the major areas of focus in political science. We have discussed the features, principles and forms of democracies and given examples of some of the models of democratic states in the world. We have also stated that monarchies declined with the growth of science, technology and industry.

ACTIVITIES:



Assignment

Assignment 3:

1. Discuss features of monarchy government in Swaziland and Morocco.
2. Assess the level of democracy in the governments of South Africa, Brazil and India.

Assessment

Assessment 3:

Discuss features of monarchy and democratic systems of government

LECTURE 4

SOCIALIST, FASCIST AND MILITARY GOVERNMENTS

INTRODUCTION



Socialist and military systems of government are dominant in human societies. Socialism as a political ideology could be traced to the writings of French philosophers in the early 19th century. However it was German philosophers namely Karl Marx and Frederick Engel's who gave this ideology a systematic form in the mid 19th century. V.I. Lenin and other Russian revolutionaries borrowed these ideas of Marx and elevated socialism to a political ideology which became the goal of the Bolshevik revolution of October 1917.

Socialist system of government began in eastern Europe in the Soviet union after the Bolshevik revolution and spread to Latin America Asia, Middle East and parts of Africa. In Africa socialism received popular support for it gave an alternative political ideology in struggling for independence. On attainment of independence in Africa.

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- To understand components that constitute socialist, authoritarian and military governments

Socialism A political ideology that is the basis of socialist governments. It is an ideology that provides for governance where the worker controls authority and economy in a state.

A system of government where soldiers or army is in control of authority and civilians are excluded from participation in administration.

Military

Fascism This a system of government that uses maximum force to promote administration that is anti-liberalism, anti democracy ,anti-socialism ,An administration that thrives on appealing to nationalist sentiments of a particular group with the purpose of promoting autonomy of that nationalist group.

(a) Socialist Governments

These are governments that developed in human societies in the 20th century. These were products of ideas propounded by Karl Marx and Frederick Engeles who wrote their treatises in the mid 19th century. These philosophers adopted a materialistic conception of analysing economic, political and social developments in society. They did argue that it is matter and not ideas that was the main force in human social transformation. Consequently, they identified two aspects that result into the types of governments in human societies. These are; mode of production and class struggle. Human societies have experienced the following mode of production; communalism, feudalism and capitalism. A mode of production determines the nature of government that develops in a society. In **communalism**, there are simple forms of government based on councils of elders, lineages, clan and family heads. The population in these modes is small and the territory where authority is exercised is also small and so there is minimal need for complex system of administration. Resources are adequate and so members of the community do not enter into conflicting relations to monopolize resources or capital. In feudalistic societies, classes begin to concretize and there are two distinct classes, the serfs (slaves) and the nobility (masters, landlords, Clergy, members of royal family). The serfs provide labour and do not get any wages or salary. It is free labour. The serfs are not allowed to participate in administration. They are perceived as property of the nobility class. The government is made up members from the nobility.

This type of government is called a monarchy. As a result of class struggle between the serfs and the nobility there is a change from feudalism to a new mode of production called **capitalism**. In

capitalism the serf (slaves) are eliminated and in return we have wage labourers who called workers or proletariats. Instead of the nobility who control the government we have the bourgeois (property owners/entrepreneurs). In a capitalist mode of production the government is a democracy. In this mode of production there is a class struggle between workers and bourgeois. The bourgeoisie aim at maximising exploitation of workers in order to get optimum profits. On the other hand the workers fight to get more wages in return of their labour and also struggle to get more involved in governance. It is this protracted struggle that eventually leads into a political conflict that matures into a revolution. This revolution then produces a socialist government and a socialist mode of production.

Socialist governments developed in Eastern Europe with the successful Bolshevik revolution of October 1917 which ushered into the international political system a Soviet Union State also called United Socialist Soviet Republics, USSR. The soviet Union translated the ideas of Karl Marx and Engels into praxis, but since the Russian empire did not have a workers class that was developed, the socialist state in soviet union was based on the ideas of Lenin, whereby it was the professional elite group that was to lead the socialist state on behalf of peasants and workers. In Soviet Union the communist and socialist government was Communist political party. It was also based on nationalization of agricultural, commercial and industrial production units. It was based on transforming the peasants and workers in the Soviet Union into state workers. Since 1917, socialist ideas spread in the developing world and facilitated the establishment of socialist governments in China and Cuba. It later spread into Middle East and Africa. In Africa socialist states were dominant in the period 1960s and 1970s, the first two decades of independence. Socialist governments declined in the 1990s, after the collapse of the Soviet Union. These governments are no longer recognised as modern governments.

(b) Fascist Governments

This is another category of governments that emerged in the global arena at the beginning of the 20th century but collapsed with the outbreak of then Second World War.

These governments emerged in Italy and Germany just before the outbreak of the Second World War. The term fascism is derived from the Latin word fascis. These were a bundle of rods that

were tied around an axe. This was a Roman symbol of authority of the civil magistrate. Fascist regime is an authoritarian form of government which was a reaction to Marxism, socialism and democracy. It is a regime that promotes nationalist sentiments among the people in order to rally them against ideological forces of Marxism, socialism and democracy. Fascism is characterised by; a regulated state-integrated economic sector, anti-liberalism, anti-communism and anti conservatism. The aim of fascist regimes and movements is to eliminate the existence of autonomy, and large scale capitalism. Fascism is best defined as a revolutionary form of nationalism, one that sets out to be a political, social and ethical revolution, wielding the people into a dynamic national community under new elites infused with basic values. Fascism is inspired by a populist, trans-class movement that called for purification, national rebirth in order to come out of decadence. Fascism was a form of political behaviour marked by obsessive pre-occupation with community decline, humiliation, victimhood and compensatory acts of unity, energy, purity in which a mass based party of committed nationalist militants working in uneasy but effective collaboration with traditional elites, abandons democratic liberties and pursues with redemptive violence and without ethical and legal restraints strived for internal cleansing and external expansion. Fascism is a set of ideologies and practices that seek to place the nation, defined in exclusive biological, cultural and historical terms, above all other sources of loyalty and to create a mobilised national community. Fascist nationalism is a reactionary in that it entails implacable hostility to socialism and feminism for they are seen as a prioritising class or gender rather than the nation. A fascist regime/government acts in the name of the people and the head of state is a charismatic leader and thus the legitimacy of a fascist state is embodied in a mass, militarised political party.

(c) Military Governments

The army is in charge of administration of the state. It forms the Executive and Judiciary arm of the government. The Legislative assemblies are absent. Fundamental liberties of speech, association and free media are suspended. The people who are the majority are marginalised from mainstream political process.

The outcome is over centralization of power which in many cases is concentrated in the hands of the Commander of the army and or a lean council of five General Commanders. Brutality, murder and use of maximum forces characterize the political culture of the state. Military governments are

common phenomenon in Africa, Middle East and Latin America. The military takes over power from civilian governments in the name of restoring democracy and securing development but usually military states oversee a constant process of economic decline and gross violation of civil, political, cultural, Social and economic rights.

SUMMARY



In this lesson we have attempted to discuss the features of socialist, fascist and military governments. Socialist form of governments disintegrated in the late 20th century, however states like China and Cuba are still struggling to maintain their socialist models of governance. Military governments are no longer recognised in the global community. Fascist states collapsed with the 2nd world war. On we could argue that socialist, military and fascist's states characterized systems of government in the 20th centuries. They are no longer regarded as viable systems of government in the 21st century.

ACTIVITIES



Assignment
Assignment 4:

Assessment

Assessment 4: Describe and analyse features of socialist, military and fascists systems of government.

LECTURE 5

POLITICS

INTRODUCTION



Politics is the fuel of governments. It is the dynamo of political science. It is argued that whereas governments are the science of political science, politics is the form of that science. Politics influence the behaviour of leaders and citizens and thus any study of political sciences incomplete without any due reference to politics.

The study of politics incorporates issues related to access and control of power, protection and protection of liberties of citizens, accountable and transparent systems of government, distribution of resources, poverty, ecology, environment, participation of all genders in governance, inter state relations, role of state corporations/multinational companies in local and international systems of governance.

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

Define politics and have an accurate understanding of the Interrelationship of politics and governance.

(1) What is Politics?

Politics is a collective activity involving people who can accept a common membership or at a least a knowledge of shared interests. It is an activity by which groups reach binding and collective decisions through attempting to reconcile political differences among their members.

Politics presumes an initial diversity of views about goals and means, processes, strategies, procedures, rules, values and ideologies in relation to the contemporary political developments or system of governance. Politics involves reconciling such differences through discussion and persuasion. Thus communication is central to politics.

It is often assumed that politics is concerned with the public sector that is parliaments, civil service, cabinets and elections and that it has minimal relations with other spheres of human activity. Similarly, there is the danger of confusing politics and making it appear and limiting it to party politics. One has to perceive politics as an activity that encompasses a whole range of human activities that have both direct and indirect effect on decision making process, distribution of resources and rights of citizens. Politics arises from disagreements and conflicting interests and those interests and differences are caused by specific issues/factors/sources.

In a nutshell one could define politics as the study of resolution of conflicts or disagreements or interests, but this resolution is determined by the distribution of power within a defined political community or state or country or region/locality. One has then to understand politics in terms of authority, power and influence.

(2) Sources of Political Conflict

Economics is one of the common sources that result into political conflicts. Scarcity of resources is one aspects of the economics dimension that lead to political activity in terms of disagreements, differences and conflicting interests. Thus, political activity results as citizens /people compete to access the limited resources at a regional level, the economic dimension could also be captured in terms of certain countries or states having resources which drive world economy. Thus international politics then revolve on how best these resources in specific states could well be utilized for the benefit of the rich and powerful states. A case in point is Oil. Oil is a resource that drives global politics.

Other sources of politics include; procedures of conducting elections, political pluralism and distribution of power.

(a) Political power

Political power could be defined as the capacity to control another's behaviour by some form of sanction. The sanctions involved may take the form of coercion or inducement; power may be backed by the carrot or the stick or by moral persuasion and it may be exercised in a positive or negative fashion (Ball2005:33). Political leaders get support from supporters by promising wealth and or honours. They may also threaten or deny these favours to the supporters. Sometimes the negative penalties for opposing the holder of power may be extreme such as imprisonment or death. These penalties are usually in the hands of those who control the institutions of the state, and those who control the state usually wield the greatest political power.

Political power is usually accompanied by authority and political authority is the recognition of the right to rule irrespective of the sanctions the ruler may possess. Power is the ability to get things done inspire of opposition. Authority is the ability to have things done without opposition. David Eaton's definition of politics as the authoritative allocation of values for a society emphasizes the importance of authority in governing

Max Weber classified authority as;

- (i) Traditional authority; the right to rule resulting from continuous exercised of power e.g. hereditary ruling families.
- (ii) Charismatic authority; this is leadership that results from exceptional personal characteristics of the personal leader e.g. Nelson Mandela or Adolph Hitler
- (ii) Legal bureaucratic or legal rational authority: here authority emanates from the political office an individual holds. The principle is on the acceptance of constitutional rules.

Political authority is buttressed and perpetuated by the use of symbols; Such as the use of the national flag or a coronation ceremony, but an important basis of political authority can be found in the pattern of political ideas.

Political power may be divorced from political authority in that the right to exercise political power may not be recognized. Leaders could possess political authority and reluctant or unable to translate

it into political power. Political power in all political systems is unequally distributed. For instance the rich possess more political resources than the poor in that they can finance election campaigns, bribe supporters and opponents. Prestige gained in non political activities e.g. the army, or a successful public profession can be trusted into political power.

(b) Pluralism

This is one of the most influential approaches to the study of distribution of power. Pluralists hold that political power in liberal democracies is widely distributed, that there is constant competition between groups and that new groups constantly develop. Decisions are outcomes of bargaining between influential groups and although political power is not evenly distributed no one group has a monopoly over power. The resolution of conflict is non violent and take the form of bargaining and procedural devices such as elections. Pluralists point out that the state is not neutral. The state is not a passive mediator between competing interests. The state in actual fact has interests in policy and politics. Critics of pluralism argue that pluralists ignore social class as a basis for elite rule.

(c) Elitism

This concept was developed by Gaetano Mosea in the early 20th century who argued that in all societies' two classes of people appear a class that rules and a class that is ruled. The rulers are a minority but monopolize power and controls resources. The ruled are the majority in population but have minimal access to resources.

(d) Corporatism re-emerged I the 1980's to analyze distribution of power in liberal democracies.

Corporatism stresses the incorporation pf large economic groups into decision making process. These large e3conomic groups include trade unions, industrial establishments and commercial establishments and agricultural establishments. The state benefits from the expertise and professionalism of these groups while the groups gain a share in the political power and recognition of their monopoly as representatives of key social sectors.

The purpose is to depoliticize decision making process so that cabinets or assemblies do not monopolize decision making process. The ultimate aim of corporatism is to enable the state gain more control on the political dynamics in the society.

SUMMARY



This unit has made a brief survey of what constitute politics and sources of political power. It has also enumerated various types of approaches that have been developed by social scientists to study power. Among these approaches include, pluralism, elitism and corporatism.

ACTIVITY



Assignment

Identify and discuss issues that propel political processes in any one of the following regions;

Europe and North America

Africa

Asia,

Middle East

Latin America.

Assessment

Assessment 5

What is politics? What approaches have been developed by scholars to study politics?

UNIT 6

PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

INTRODUCTION



The word administer is derived from two Latin words ad and ministrue which means to dispense (e.g. dispensation of medicine, service or justice). It also means to control or manage people. In literal terms administration is the management of affairs which include both public and private. Public administration refers to management of public affairs in order to achieve maximum efficiency in service delivery. It is the study of state's activities.

Public administration in a sense provides a framework for implementation of state policies. The objective of public administration is delivery of public services and achievement of public goals. I.e. delivery of education, housing, water, electricity, medicare, transport, food. Public administration entails a study of;

Organization of public administration, Service delivery in public organs and how public administration interacts with the society.

Public administration as a field of study can be defined as the study of management of public agencies that carry out public policies in order to fulfil the purpose of the state in the public interest. As an activity public administration is a handmaid of government. Public administration engages in the following activities; regulate behaviour, extract taxes, distribute benefits, organise bureaucracies, national defence and security, ensure welfare of citizens, environmental protection, covers all operations and activities of institutions in the corporate sector which depend on government funding. Thus public administration consists of; public policy analysis, public personnel, administration environment and public financial administration.

OBJECTIVE



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- You will be able to define public administration and elements that constitute public administration

Public
administration

Management of public affairs in accordance with rules, procedures, policies and laws as provided for in the constitution and the penal code.

(a) Public Policy

This is concerned with the process of policy making, the contents of policy and implementation and output of policies in other words a study of service delivery.

(b) Public Personnel

This concerned with manpower which may include: recruitment, training, remuneration, promotion, retirement, employer-employee relation (industrial relations). The efficiency of any organization depends on the capacity of the employees.

©Administration environment

This is the interaction of public administration with political, social, cultural and even economic environments. One of the issues is whether public administration should be pre determined by the environment or be left to technocrats or professionals.

(d) Public Financial administration

This involves the process of financial preparation, enactment and execution of the budget, accounting and auditing. Financial management is a key to effective public administration.

Bureaucracy

This is a common concept that characterizes public administration. According to Rod Hague (1998), bureaucracy is the states engine. Bureaucracy consists of permanent salaried officials employed by the state to advise on and carry out the policies of the political executive. In contrast to the personal advisers surrounding a ruling monarch, a modern bureaucracy is a public institution with recruitment on merit and an emphasis on the consistent application of clear rules to individual cases.

The term bureaucracy comes from the old French term burel, meaning the cloth used to cover a writing desk or bureau.

Characteristics of Bureaucracy

According to Max Weber, bureaucracy is governed by a set of rules that are easily discernible. He considered bureaucracy as an impersonal system operating on the basis of clearly defined rules. Bureaucracy is based on the level of rational-authority which is a form of authority found in organizations. Max Weber's model has the following features of bureaucracy;

- A career structure in which promotions are based on merit
- Officials are appointed not elected on the basis of free contract where officials are free to sign.
- Employees are personally free and subject to their impersonal official duties
- Each department has clearly defined sphere of work as provided for in the law or policies.
- Employment is based on professional qualifications
- Administrative offices are hierarchically disciplined in which officials are subject to the authority of their superior

These features made administration efficient and rational. Bureaucracy is based on the following principles:

- Rules; bureaucracy operates according to the fixed written duties which specify

authority, rights and duties as employers and modes of doing work.

- Rationality; it represents a rational form of authority which is based upon law, regulations and statutes. It does not leave room for irrationality in decision making. In making decisions there is no such place as love and hatred.
- Neutrality: Bureaucracy operates in the absence of bias. It is not intrinsic to any political ideology but can exist in any society.
- Records: Administration is based on written records. The records contain acts, decisions, procedures and rules which are referred to for future action.
- Division of Labour; organizational task is broken down to well defined specific functions. Every person has outlined duties and authority. Each person does specific defined tasks.
- Hierarchy; Organization of administration emphasizes the principles of hierarchical arrangement of offices. There is an order of protocol in which lower offices is under authority of the higher office. Bureaucracy creates a system of superior subordinate relationships each official is accountable to his/her superior.
- Impersonality; the official business is completed without regards for any persons. Officials are not influenced by the sentiments or emotions of any person in dealing with issues of administration. The officials stick to lay down procedures and regulations in dispensing service or decisions in any matter before them.

Challenges facing Bureaucracy as the engine of public administration.

In studying bureaucracy particularly in developing countries, political scientists have raised the following question:

Does bureaucracy promote development or is it a barrier to development?

One of the responses to the question raised above is that bureaucracy can be a catalyst and or a challenge to development. This is because bureaucracy is never impersonal, predictable and precise as held by Max Weber. Bureaucrats are human beings who resort back to use of informal methods in decision making. It has also to be pointed out that bureaucracy can also be affected by the environment either social, economic political or cultural. All these factors collaborate to twist bureaucracy towards directions that do not conform to its scientific nature.

Another challenge to bureaucracy is that corruption is well entrenched in bureaucracies. Bureaucrats often bend rules and regulations to suit their relatives and benefactors.

Public administration is the study of public entities and their relationship with each other and with the larger world. It consists of how public policy structures the design of government programs. It also involves a study of how states, cities and towns work with federal government or central government in order to achieve set out goals and future plans. Public administration addresses issues of how national governments formulates and change public policy to respond to respond to the needs and interests of the people in a nation.

SUMMARY



In this unit you learned:

This unit has defined public administration and elaborated on the major components of public administration. In the lesson we have defined bureaucracy as one of the manifestations inherent in public administration. We have outlined the features and principles of bureaucracy. Lastly we have summarised public administration as the engine of the state.

ACTIVITIES



Assignment 6

Discuss similarities and differences between public administration in Kenya and USA.

Assessment

Assessment 6

What is public administration? Examine the main features and principles of public administration and demonstrate how bureaucracy is a barrier to development in Africa.

UNIT 7 INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

INTRODUCTION



This is a component of social science study that emerged as a distinct field of inquiry in the inter war period, 1919 -1939. In the United Kingdom International relations developed as an independent discipline which took the name of international politics. In the United States of America, international relations developed as a sub discipline of political science.

International relations have been influenced by the paradigm of realism and neo realism in its growth.

The realism paradigm is based on the following claims; that the sovereign state is the most important actor in international politics. Secondly, state behaviour can be explained rationally, thirdly states are unitary actors, fourthly, that there is a sharp distinction between domestic and

international politics, Fifthly that states pursue power in an anarchical self help setting and that the issues of peace and war are paramount. Arend Lijphart among other scholars have emphasized these tenets in the study of international relations

Morgenthau has advanced the neorealist position in the study of international relations and argued that international politics, like politics in general, was characterized by a continuous for power. The struggle was qualitatively different in the international field where an overarching central authority was missing. The notion which would later become the cardinal claim of neorealist that the international system was characterized by a condition of anarchy, differentiated domestic politics from international politics. The exclusive focus that neorealist placed on the anarchical structure of the international system subsequently came to provide the predominant framework for analyzing a wide variety of issues in the areas of international security, international organization, foreign policy and political economy. In the inter war period focus in the study of international relations was conducted in the tradition of idealism which emphasized war and peace.

Other paradigms used to study international relations include; behaviouralism paradigm, world politics paradigm, global society and neo-Marxist paradigms and pluralism (Walter Carlsnares etl, 2002)

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- Have a general understanding of what constitutes international relations

Realism This is a collective set of ideas in the field of international relations that emphasize the central role of the state in world politics and organization.

Paradigm Theory of knowledge or systematic manner of organising and presenting Knowledge.

Issues in International Relations

- (a) Foreign Policy; this is a dominant issue in International relations. Foreign policy consists of self interest strategies chosen by the states to safeguard their national interests and to achieve its goals within the international system. The strategies are deliberately and consciously located to respond positively and or negatively with interests of other states in the international system. As a result of globalization and translational activities, states do not just relate with each other in the international system but also interact with non state actors. The interaction is evaluated and monitored in attempts to maximize benefits of multilateral international cooperation. Non state actors do include; Non governmental Organizations, Multinational companies/state corporations, United Nations Agencies such as UCEF, UNIFEM, UN habitat, UNESCO, UNDP, UNIDO, UNEP, UNHCR. Other non state actors include; World Health Organization (WHO), Food Agricultural Organization (FAO) General Agreement of Trade Tariffs (GATT), World Trade Organization (WTO).
- (b) War and Peace: the conventional understanding of war and peace in international relations is that nation A is either at war or at peace with nation B. This is the case/norm in any two interacting states or groups. In international relations, war and peace are interdependently interconnected and interrelated and they are aspects of the same phenomena.

The difference between peace and war are relative within an all embracing unit. Such pair of opposites constitutes a poor relationship where each of the two poles is diametrically linked to the other

- (c) Security Cooperation; Security is defined as the absence of existence of threats from one state against other state (states). However security could also refer to social, global and human dimensions. Societal security could refer to security for social, ethical, religious and or cultural minorities. Global or world security refers to security of people and states at the global level. Human security denotes individual's basic needs and rights.

Security cooperation then involves identifying and enhancing collaboration and forming alliances among state and non state actors. Disarmament is one of the strategies of forging security cooperation among states/groups. Non state actors such as civil society organizations do use humanistic approaches e.g., dialogue, lobbying, sensitization, persuasion to prevail upon conflicting

parties or states or groups to consent to disarm and surrender weapons that accelerate insecurity. Individual benevolent individuals such as Henri Dunant the founder of Red Cross, play decisive roles in security cooperation. Henri Dunant, the founder of the committee of Red Cross managed to promote the idea of limiting carnage in war time and excessive cruelty into high politics that contributed to security cooperation

(d) Peace Making and Conflict Resolution

The modern study of international relations originated in the 20th century experience of global war and the desire to avoid subsequent war. State and non state actors have developed strategies to promote peace;

This includes the political project of democracy because Scholars like Raymond (1998) argued that democratic states are likely to seek international arbitration to resolve disputes as opposed to dictatorships who would resort to military power. Peace keeping forces have also been employed by the international community to keep peace. Other strategies in conflict resolution and peace making involve; mediation and dialogue.

(e) Nationalism and Ethnicity

Nationalism in international relations analyses how politics of national identity and nation states influence conflicts within the international system. Ethnicity and nationalism are related in that ethnic nationalism causes ethnic conflicts.

Studies in international relations do focus on methods of ethnic conflict resolution and management. John Cockley for instance, developed a typology of the methods that states have used in conflict resolution and such methods are; indigenization, accommodation, assimilation, acculturation, population transfer, boundary alteration, genocide and ethnic suicide.

(f) International Finance

International finance is a core substantive element in the field of international relations. A key factor that distinguishes international finance from purely domestic monetary analysis is the existence of separate national currencies. Legally the concept of state sovereignty has long been understood to include an exclusive right to create and manage money within national frontiers where the local currency is the major medium of exchange, unit of account and store of value. In the international monetary system there is a universe of diverse national monetary spaces not a homogenous entity. The existence of separate national currencies has economic and political implications. Monetary sovereignty means that currencies that are legal tender in one country/state are unlikely, with few exceptions, to be fully usable. International finance puts in place mechanism and arrangements such as foreign exchange and other financial markets to facilitate transactions and interchanges between national moneys and credit system.

Other issues in international relations include; international development, international human rights, international organizations international environment and international law.

SUMMARY



This lesson has given an exposition of the key aspects that constitute the study of international relations. It has shown that international relations is growing into an independent discipline from political science. It is in the process of refining its methodology and content. However, it is still a new discipline whose history is located in the interwar period.

ACTIVITIES



Assignment 7

Assignment

Using examples discuss the position of Africa in international politics and show how this position affects Africa relations with Europe and North America

Discuss the impact of China as a rising economic power house on international relations

How has USA influenced the agenda of international relations in the post second world war period?

Assessment

Using examples discuss the position of Africa in international politics and show how this position affects Africa relations with Europe and North America

Discuss the impact of China as a rising economic power house on international relations

How has USA influenced the agenda of international relations in the post second world war period?

Assessment 7

What are international relations and what are its core components.

LECTURE 8

ELEMENTS OF POLITICS

INTRODUCTION



Politics is derived from numerous issues and factors. However the following components constitute the engine of politics in modern states. These are: political parties and electoral systems, pressure groups/interest groups and civil society organizations, political culture, representation, elections and voting. The military is another component of politics in the developing world.

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- Familiar with the elements that drive the political process in modern states.
- You will have an accurate understanding of the roles of political parties, elections, military and social cleavages in the political process.

Social cleavages

Classes or groups with defined interests in a political community.

(1) Political parties and electoral systems

Political parties are defined by their aim of seeking political power either singularly or in cooperation with other political parties. The aim of every political party is to prevail over the others in order to get into power or to stay in it. It is this goal of attaining political power that distinguishes political parties from other groups in the political system.

Political parties present candidates and leaders to the electorate and seek to mobilise the support of the electorate by propaganda, organized activities and emphasising differences with other parties. Political parties play the following roles in the political system;

- (i) Mediate between the demands of the public and the formal institutions of decision making by Government.
- (ii) Channel and aggregate demands of the electorate to the government. Parties seek to broaden the range of interests they represent and harmonize these interests with each other.
- (iii) They provide an institutional means for relating the people with the government. The parties educate/instruct and activate the electorate using mass media, public rallies and party congresses to sensitize people on their rights, government policies and programmes and thereby push the party agenda.

(iv) Political parties perform the important function of recruiting political leaders. Parties create political opportunity structures for present and future leaders. The parties' present issues and ideas which give alternative value goals for society in ways that may enhance the opportunities of choosing such alternatives. It is these ideas that form the philosophy and later ideological dimension of a political party.

Political parties develop their structure in respect to their ideology and philosophy however political parties have had the following party structures: caucus, branch and cell. The caucus or committee is a small membership which resists wider membership and emphasises quality in membership and leadership potential and concentrates on electoral activities but is dormant in the inter election period. A branch party is a mass party with branch network across the state/country. Branch parties have continuous activities in and between elections. The basic units are Wards /constituencies and or districts/counties. The cell political structure was invented by socialist parties in Eastern Europe .The basic unit is based on the place of work and not branch network on the basis of geographical location. The cell is secretive and aims at instilling discipline in members and ensuring that official party policy and ideology is maintained at all times. The cell enhances efficient communication in parties.

Political parties are classified in terms of; one party system, multi-party system and dominant party systems. One party systems were dominant in the post second world war period but have collapsed with the disintegration of the Soviet Union in 1992. These parties were dominant in Africa, Latin America and eastern Europe. Multi-parties refer to a stable political environment where numerous parties compete for power for selling/marketing their manifesto in order to get to power. We also have a multi-party state where only two parties dominate the political arena.

This is common in developed countries such as New Zealand, Britain and USA.

In New Zealand and Britain the labour party and conservative parties are the two actors in the political arena. In USA, we have the Democratic and the Republican parties.. Multi-party systems also have what is called dominant political parties such India where the congress party has been the major factor in the political process.

(2) Electoral systems

This refers to the organization and procedures that define participation in elections.

There exist the following electoral systems:

(i) Single member system which is divided into:

Single member constituency and single vote. Here a plurality of votes is required to win a constituency seat in elections, this is a system used in USA Britain and Canada. The second system is called single member and second ballot. This refers to a situation where a second ballot is organised when a candidate does not secure absolute majority in the ballot. This system is used in France. There is also the single member with preferential vote. This system allows a voter to place candidates in order of preference, then the votes of the weaker candidate are distributed among the strong candidates. Australia uses this type of elector system.

(ii) Proportional representation

The objective of this system is to allocate seats in close proportion to the votes cast in multi-members constituencies. The two principal types of this system are; list system and single transferable vote. The citizen votes for a list of candidates presented by a political party and each party wins a seat in that constituency according to the votes for that party list. The list system is popular in Europe in countries like Belgium, Italy, Sweden and Denmark. In single transferable vote, mark all candidates in order of preference, when votes are counted an electoral quota is established that is the minimum number of votes needed by a candidate to win one of the seats, the surplus vote are redistributed to the other candidates according to the voters order of preference. This redistribution eliminates weaker candidates until the winning candidate is found. Northern Ireland uses this system of electoral process.

(3) Pressure groups

This describes organizations that attempt to influence public policy. Pressure groups are also described as lobby groups, interest groups political groups. Interest groups are those groups whose members share attitudes resulting from common objective characteristics e.g. Members are farmers, business people etc. Members of a promotional group or attitude group hold certain values

in common irrespective of their background. Pluralists hold the view that pressure groups play a big role in liberal democracies. Competing group interaction determines the outcome of many political conflicts and also provide wide avenues of political participation and ensures increased distribution of power in liberal democracies. Interest groups seek to promote their own particular interest's vis-à-vis the political authorities. Conversely the political authorities enter into relations with these groups, occasionally to support them, sometimes to control them, frequently to associate them with their own actions. An interest group is thus distinguished from other groups by the fact that it interacts in some way or the other with the state institutions and the parties engaged in the struggle to win and exercise power (Yves many and Andrew Knapp 1998: 123). Pressure groups apply their pressure on the executive, legislature and judiciary to amend or enact law, policies and procedures.

(4) Representation, Elections and voting behaviour

The liberal theories of representation emphasises the importance of individual rights, the inviolability of the individuals property and the necessity of limiting the powers of government to protect those rights. The justification of these rights was found in the theories of natural rights that were beyond the competency of any government interference. The second dimension of representation is on the rationalist strand of human beings, thus an individual uses his/her vote in an intelligent manner and is consequently entitled to share in the selection of representatives. The third theory of representation brings out the sovereignty of the people which is expressed in universal suffrage.

The British reformist tradition in the 19th century measured its success by the successive reform acts which increased the size of the electorate, attempts to equalize the size of constituencies, the introduction of the secrete ballot, attack on corrupt electoral practices and the weakening of the unrepresentative house of Lords.(Ball,2005).

Liberal democracy emphasizes the role of the representative assembly as a protection against the encroachment of executive power, especially encroachments on the liberties of the individual. In this framework the representative has a definite role. He/she represents a geographical opinion of opinions. During the debates of the American constitution in 1788 Alexander Hamilton observed” Men love power. Give power to the many, they will oppress the few, Give all power to the few,

they will oppress the many. Both ought to have power, that they may defend itself from each other (quoted in Dahl1976:).

Elections are universally a means of choosing representatives. Elections allow voter participation in the choosing of their representatives. The successful candidate may be the choice of the majority, or the system may give the parties control over which candidates are presented to the electorate. Voters in a single transferable vote have a greater choice over which candidate should represent a particular political party than voters in two distinct political party system like that of Britain.

Referenda are a means of allowing voters to directly influence decision makers in terms of specific policies and even constitution. Referenda are common means of making policy in Switzerland, Referenda have been held in Sweden on alcohol, In Irish Republic on abortion, in California on tax cutting etc.

The problem of electoral corruption in newer liberal democracies is crucial in setting up norms of fairness and equal access in elections early in their history becomes a means of institutionalising an open democratic system.

Elections have functions other than those concerned with the choice and accountability of representatives or governments. Elections provide for communications between the rulers and the ruled. Elections legitimize the right of rulers to govern.

There is no agreement on why voters choose certain individuals or political parties.. In a democracy voting is perceived as a fundamental right and large scale political mobilization has been needed to secure this right and large scale political mobilization has been needed to secure this right for women and members of minority groups. In countries such as Belgium and Australia voting is mandatory, indicating that the framers of basic laws have considered this form of participation crucial to maintaining democracy. The rational choice approach allows the voter to vote on the record of the government, making a retrospective judgement and thus to ignore the promises of candidates and parties.

(5) Military

The military is common in states which do not have developed democracies. Military interventions in political life in developing world are a common phenomenon. The political influence of the military stretches from complete political control of government to complete subservience of the military to other political structures. The military is involved in replacing one civilian government with another. The military could also act as the main political support for a civilian government. In other instances the military behaves as one of the many pressure groups within the political system, using the methods of influence, and applying methods acceptable within that system.

The structure of the armed forces is hierarchical and centralized, placing a premium on rapid communications. Discipline and obedience to higher commands is of fundamental importance. The military monopolizes chief instruments of legitimate violence in the political system. The values of the military stand above sectional, vested interest conflicts in politics as the embodiment of the national interest, albeit in authoritarian, disciplined conception of the national interest. Yet the same military in some developing countries is dominated by one ethnic group and this becomes centres of conflict in society. The genocide in Rwanda was in part a result of a clear case of an army perceived as representing one contending ethnic group. Mexico on the contrary is an example where the military is broadly representative of the population and does not present a challenge to civilian authority. The military intervenes in politics in a state because of two factors. One is because some armed forces are more professional than others. Lack of professionalism in an army will easily trigger the military to intervene in politics and conspire to take over power. Secondly, the nature of the political system in one way or the other influences the military to be directly involved in politics. Direct military intervention in politics is less likely to take place in industrialized liberal democracies. However, in states in which civilian governments lack prestige and legitimacy, there is serious weakness in such governments where the military takes advantage of and intervenes in politics.

It follows that the military is one group among many attempting to influence decision making and the controls are essentially similar to those exercised over other groups. In the United States of America, the size of the military budget, the sophisticated machinery of the military and the influence of the military in foreign policy has created fears that the armed forces are exercising too great an influence on political decision making. Yet civilian supremacy is a fundamental principle of US government has to abide by the decisions of the civilian government.

(6) Constitutions and the judiciary

One of the oldest political demands is that a sovereign/king/prime minister/president be bound by laws. In England for example, the concept of laws that were open, public and respected as well as enforced by the King was at the core of Magna Carta. Such public demand has wide implications namely, that the sovereign be denied the power to make up laws to suit the needs of the moment, that the law be applied consistently and impartially with recognized processes and independent judges.. It also included the notion of a higher, divine or natural law which could not be overturned even by the most solemn legislative process.(Yves Meny and Andrew Knapp1998:320).

The constitution is a fundamental law and thus any laws that are inconsistent with the constitution are null and void. This is because the constitution is a product of popular consensus and a social pact and as a supreme law of the land it expresses the will of the people.

Administrative courts and tribunals have emerged as important ingredients of modern political systems. Similarly judges and courts of law are aspects of the complete political process. Robert Dahl (1998) noted; To consider the supreme court of the United States as a legal institution is to underestimate its significance in the American political system. It is also a political institution, for it arrives at decisions on questions of national policy.

The judiciary is part of the political process because of two factors; one liberal democratic theory has traditionally placed a premium on the need to protect the citizen from a too powerful state and has therefore emphasised the impartiality of the judicial process, the independence of the judiciary and the need to deepen the respect and confidence with which judicial decisions are received.

Second the growth of quasi-judicial institutions has led to emphasizing some aspects of the doctrine of separation of powers, both to prevent too much concentration of political power in the hands of the government and to guard against the excesses of democracy or the tyranny of the majority (Ball2005 253).

SUMMARY



In this unit you learned:

This chapter has made a comprehensive overview of elements that constitute politics. We have examined the role of political parties, pressure groups, electoral systems, judiciary and the military in the political process. We have shown how each of the components engages the government to enhance their participation in decision making process.

ACTIVITIES



Assignment

Assignment 8

What would you consider to be the role of political parties and pressure groups in the politics of Africa

Critically examine the role of constitution making process and the judiciary in the politics of Africa

What issues still propel the military to directly intervene in the political process in Africa?

Assessment

Assessment 8

Discuss the role of political parties, pressure groups and electoral systems in the politics of Africa.

In what ways is constitution making process and functions of the judiciary a product of politics in a society, use case studies to illustrate your answer?

LECTURE 9

POLITICAL THEORY

INTRODUCTION



There is no consensus among political theorists as to what constitute the discipline of political theory. Among the main topics addressed under political theory include; history of political thought, political concepts such as; freedom, equality, democracy, feminism, socialism, anarchy and liberalism. The areas of enquiry that political theorists explore are constantly changing and with this our understanding of what qualifies as political theory is not static John Plamenatz described political theory as the systematic thinking about the purposes of government (Plamenatz 1960;37).

Political theory is concerned with how things ought to be as opposed to how things actually are. While political scientists ask for instance “How the American or British political system is different from other countries or who actually wields power in a political system?” The political theorists will ask “Who should wield political power in society and what ideals, principles and institutional arrangements can best secure the diverse demands of justice?” Political theory is concerned with understanding liberalism, communitarianism, multiculturalism, deliberative democracy and feminism.

OBJECTIVES



Upon completion of this unit you will be able to:

- Give a precise definition of political theory
- Identify and analyze various aspects of political theory

Political theory This is a critical analysis of political philosophies that impact on politics and governments in human societies.

(1) Liberalism

The just society according to John Rawls a leading 20th century political philosopher, is one that protects citizen’s basic liberties and arranges socio-economic inequalities so that they benefit the

least advantaged in society.. This view of Rawls is in opposition to that of Robert Nozick whose conception of justice is closely intertwined with the state. He defended the minimal state.

He argued that the state should be limited to the narrow functions of protection against force, theft, fraud, enforcement of contracts etc. Thus any state that extends its functions beyond this narrow range of functions is unjust. Such an extensive state violates peoples rights(Farrelly 2004) Rawls theory of justice as fairness is primarily concerned with the way in which major social institutions distribute fundamental rights and duties and determine the division of advantages from social cooperation. The just society according to Rawls is governed by two principles; namely each person has the same indefensible claim to a fully adequate scheme of equal basic liberties. Secondly, social and economic inequalities are to satisfy two conditions; first they are to be attached to offices and positions open to all under conditions of fair equality of opportunity and to be the greatest benefit of the least advantaged members of society.

Liberalism is the foundation of democracy. Liberalism is the philosophy of institutions.. The term liberal first made its appearance in Spain at the beginning of the 19th century when it was used to denote, the promoters of the Cadiz Constitution of 1812. It then spread to Britain (through the writing of Bent ham) and France where men like Benjamin Constant discussed human liberties.. The liberals favoured a constitutional system of government that would guarantee both individual liberties and property within the framework of a political system that was moderate and balanced (Yves Meny and Andrew Knapp 1998:56-57) . The driving force of the early liberal movement in Europe was the struggle against arbitrary power exercised by Kings and the legal privileges of the landed nobility. In 18th century the English people enjoyed liberties though they were not included in the laws. These liberties namely, freedom from arbitrary arrest, arbitrary search, arbitrary taxation equality before the law, the right to trial by jury, degree of freedom of thought, speech, conscience and the freedom to buy and sell. The development of liberty in the 18th century produced a government guided by two principals, government by consent and civil liberty. The first principle meant that government was conceived as a partnership between government and the people expressed in a contract. If the leadership broke the contract the people were freed from their duty to obey. Government was not regarded as the all powerful but as a convenient and necessary device for securing certain objectives, chief among them was the maximum freedom of citizens to pursue their private affairs as equal members of the society.

The French revolution led to a declaration of the rights of man which stated that the aim of all political association was to preserve the natural and imprescriptible rights of man. It provided for the separation of powers in government and the rule of law and declared that free communication of thought and opinion was the most precious rights of all. The question of democracy came on the forefront after the French revolution. If all men had natural rights and the state existed to protect those rights then all men ought to have a say in choosing the government and participating in politics.. Liberal constitutionalism was one of the main strands in liberalism. Liberty in the form of civil and political rights was the purpose that made a government to be established. i.e. in order to secure these rights. Democracy was one means i.e the most superior means of choosing leaders in a modern state to exercise executive functions.. Liberalism represented a government of laws and not a government of men. Everyone was equal before the law. The role of the state was to remove obstacles to the dynamism of the civil society. Government had to have separate functions in form of legislature (this was the sovereign body), judiciary and executive. In the 19th century there was a conflict in liberal philosophy where scholars like Bentham and John Stuart Mill did argue that human beings were rational and their actions were pre determined by maximum utility hence the rise of utilitarianism as opposed to natural rights. This utilitarianism was dismissed in the 20th century By John Rawls who advocated for justice as fairness.(Gamble 1981:68;91)

(2) Communitarianism

Liberal communitarianism was a popular political theory in the 1980's. and 1990's. The two proponents of this communitarian theory are Michael Sandel and Michael Walzer. Communitarians disagree with the central position of the self/individual in the construction of justice. Sandel notes "The liberal political philosophy propounds the central idea that government should be neutral toward the moral and religious views its citizens espouse. Since people disagree about the best way to live, government should not affirm in law any particular vision of the good life. Instead it should provide a framework of rights that respects persons as free and independent selves capable of choosing their own values and ends. This liberalism affirms the public life which could be described as a procedural republic.

Michael Walzer on the other hand differs with the methodology of liberals in constructing justice. As proponent of communitarianism he strongly argued that justice should take into consideration,

the history, culture and membership of different societies. Communitarianism point out that each community, creates its own social goods and thus what each community thinks should justly be distributed will vary from culture to culture. There aren't one or two fundamental principles that govern the regulation of all social goods. Communitarians state that in one community there is plurality of principles to regulate the plurality of goods. For example the methodology of distributing health care and education depends on what these social goods mean in a given community.

Sandels noted that with the decline with the community has come decline with for the common good. Politics argued Sandel needs to be concerned with restoring civic spaces, places where people can engage in debate about the common good. But the neutral state is not concerned with cultivating civic virtues.

(3) Multiculturalism

Multiculturalism is a product of liberal communitarianism. Multiculturalism is based on the principle that we should resist the wider society's homogenizing tendency or assimilation and the belief that there is only one correct, true, or normal way to understand and structure the relevant areas of life. Multiculturalism emphasizes the aspect that justice requires equal rights of all citizens irrespective of gender, religion, race, ethnicity, disability.

It is unjust for instance to exclude women, or Catholics, or Muslims or afro Americans from exercising the rights other citizens enjoy, like freedom of expression, and the right to vote.. Multiculturalists promote aspirations of such communities as the indigenous peoples, national minorities, sub national groups and the immigrants. Multiculturalists thus endorse the politics of recognition which inspires a public philosophy premised on the principles of identity and difference instead of the principle of equal citizenship. The politics of recognition requires that everyone should be recognised for his or her unique identity. Multiculturalist defends minority national rights. And even seek material and financial and legal protection rights.

(4) Deliberative Democracy

Since the 1990's there has been a turn on focus from distributive democracy to deliberative democracy. This paradigm shift has been occasioned by debates on the relation between democracy and justice. It is argued that this relation was marginalising by distributive democracy.

Democracy has been divided into many different conceptions e.g. participatory, social democracy, distributive democracy, deliberative democracy among others. Democracy in political terms entails a process of giving all citizens in a state or country entitlement to an equal vote and the vote of the majority is binding. This simple definition of democracy ignores factors such as; in a situation where citizens have only an option of voting one political party then their choice is already prescribed and does not meet the ideals of democracy. Robert Dahl (1998) enumerates the following aspects that constitute democracy. Which include; effective participation, equality in voting, gaining enlightened understanding, exercising final control over the agenda and inclusion of adults..

Deliberative democracy places emphasis on the opportunities for effective participation and gaining enlightened understanding. Aggregative democracy conceives voting as the primary political activity because it maintains that policy formation should be based on the preferences of the majority. The basic elements of deliberative democracy are searching for consensus, being open minded and respecting even accommodating your opponent's position.

To participate in the consensus building process as envisioned by deliberative democracy is to engage in transformative process. Aggregative democracy is based on voting and bargaining.

These two conceptions of democracy all emphasize equality. (Farrelly, 2004: 137-143).

(5) Feminism is a political theory puts emphasis on eliminating the oppression of women. Thus a liberal feminists holds the view that a liberal framework of rights correctly conceived could put an end to the subordination of women whilst a socialist feminist believes that class exploitation and gender exploitation and gender exploitation are interconnected and this he latter could not be achieved without eliminating the former. Feminists emphasise that gender distinctions are socially constructed. Gender is the deeply entrenched institutionalization of sexual difference. Differences between men and women stem from unequal power relations. Some feminists align themselves

with liberalism whilst others see liberalism as thoroughly patriarchal ideology and thus they construct their normative theories.

SUMMARY



In this unit you learned:

This chapter has examined various types of political theories ranging from liberalism, communitarianism, multiculturalism, deliberative democracy and feminism. In the lesson we have show how these philosophies influence politics and governance. We have attempted to define political theory within the parameters of liberalism. We have not discussed socialism and anarchism as political philosophies because they have been overtaken by history.

ACTIVITIES



Assignment 9

To what extent can communitarian liberal theory enhance the study of politics and government in Africa?

What are the main tenets of socialism and anarchism and what has led to the decline of these political philosophies?

Assessment

Assessment 9

Describe and analyse the components of liberalism, multiculturalism, deliberative democracy and feminism.

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